AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS XII EXAMINATION

APRIL/ MAY 2018

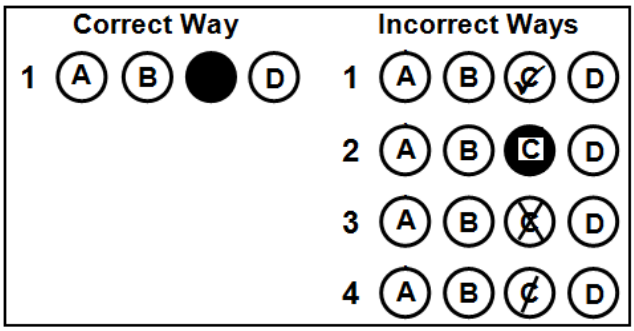
English Compulsory Paper I

Time: 55 minutes Marks: 40

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INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read each question carefully.
2. Answer the questions on the separate answer sheet provided. DO NOT write your answers on the question paper.
3. There are 100 answer numbers on the answer sheet. Use answer numbers 1 to 40 only.
4. In each question there are four choices A, B, C, D. Choose ONE. On the answer grid black out the circle for your choice with a pencil as shown below.



Candidate's Signature

5. If you want to change your answer, ERASE the first answer completely with a rubber, before blacking out a new circle.
6. DO NOT write anything in the answer grid. The computer only records what is in the circles.

Listening Comprehension Section

In this section, you will hear two passages. Each one will be played two times.

Listen carefully to the first passage and then read questions 1 to 10. You will have two minutes' reading time.

The passage will be played one more time. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the passage has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have four minutes to record your answers.

Follow the instructions on the front page of Paper I to show which of the options, A, B, C or D, you have selected for each question.

Listening Passage I

This passage talks about the evolution of chocolate as a dessert.

Source: Adapted from *The History of Chocolate* by Deanna Pucciarelli TED Talks

Now listen to the passage.

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

1. The beginning of the speech asserts that

   A. chocolate is essential for life.
   B. most people love chocolate.
   C. chocolate is produced in certain parts of the world.
   D. Mesoamericans discovered chocolate before the 16th century.

2. The speaker tells us that before chocolate was used as a dessert, it was used as a

   A. spice.
   B. drink.
   C. foam.
   D. vegetable.

3. The speaker refers to the ancient civilization of Aztecs in order to prove that chocolate was

   A. famous in Europe.
   B. used by ill soldiers.
   C. precious and valued.
   D. used by people from the East.

4. Who introduced chocolate to the rest of the world?

   A. The Spanish conquerors
   B. The soldiers who lived amongst the Aztecs
   C. The Europeans who returned from Aztec court
   D. The courtiers who introduced chocolate to the Spanish Emperor

5. In 1900 BCE, chocolate was MOSTLY used by

   A. those who got ill.
   B. royals and the elite.
   C. villagers and commoners.
   D. those who grew cacao beans.

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6. The growth of chocolate industry increasingly violated human rights because

   A. not enough money was paid by the Western companies.
   B. underage people were employed or enslaved.
   C. 2 million adults were forced to work as labourers.
   D. Western nations did not sign any agreement with the African nations.

7. The speaker says that "chocolate has established itself in the rituals of our modern culture." She means that chocolate is

   A. an important aspect of our social life.
   B. a representation of modernity and financial superiority.
   C. very important for economic prosperity as it generates profits.
   D. used by those people who ignore the cruel practices of chocolate industry.

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8. The speaker says that 'with the growth of the chocolate industry, there have been horrific abuses of human rights'. Most of the human beings affected are from the

   A. Aztec civilization.
   B. West African nations.
   C. West European nations.
   D. ancient Eastern civilizations.

9. The speaker ends her speech by advising

   A. us not to eat chocolate.
   B. advertising companies to be morally cautious.
   C. us to be mindful of cruel practices of chocolate industry.
   D. us to be careful while eating chocolate because it is unhealthy.

10. The MAIN purpose of the entire text is to

   A. describe varying tastes of chocolate.
   B. discuss chocolate's popularity in the world.
   C. explain the journey of chocolate through the years.
   D. discuss abuse of human rights in the chocolate trade.

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Now, we will play the second passage. It will also be played two times.

Listen carefully to the first playing, and then read questions 11 to 20. You will have two minutes' reading time.

The passage will be played one more time. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the passage has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have four minutes to record your answers.

Listening Passage II

In this passage, the speaker describes why the tomb of Genghis Khan cannot be found.

Source: Adapted from *Why Genghis Khan's Tomb Cannot Be Found* by BBC Travel

Now listen to the passage.

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

11. The speech begins by describing the

    A. weather of Mongolia.
    B. landscape of Mongolia.
    C. legend of Genghis Khan.
    D. horses used by Genghis Khan.

12. The activities of the speaker, as mentioned in the beginning of the speech, indicate that she is

    A. travelling alone.
    B. a native of Mongolia.
    C. a horse riding enthusiast.
    D. travelling with a group of tourists.

13. The speaker says, "Ömnögovi Province is endless by car." She means that

    A. it is very big.
    B. it is very small.
    C. she is near its end.
    D. her journey has just begun.

14. The FIRST information given about Genghis Khan is that he

    A. was a great hero.
    B. conquered the world on horseback.
    C. pioneered the use of postal services.
    D. was involved in kidnapping and bloodshed.

15. Genghis Khan ruled everything between the Pacific Ocean and the Caspian Sea. The information given immediately after this is that he

    A. was buried by his army as per his wishes.
    B. was the greatest war hero of Mongolia.
    C. conquered the world and civilized it.
    D. wished his gravesite to be concealed.

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16. According to the speaker, when Genghis Khan was buried, his soldiers rode a 1,000 horses over his grave. This was done to

    A. hide the grave.
    B. show disrespect.
    C. express their grief.
    D. honour the emperor.

17. According to the speaker, mostly foreigners are interested in finding the grave of Genghis Khan. The reason mentioned by the speaker for this is that the grave is

    A. believed to contain a great treasure.
    B. of vast international interest as a historic site.
    C. considered to be a sacred site for the Mongols.
    D. supposed to equip the finder with mythical powers.

18. Which evidence presented by the speaker MOST closely indicates that Genghis Khan is respected widely across Mongolia in the current era?

    A. His deeds are taught in schools.
    B. His face is on Mongolian currency.
    C. His bravery is considered unparalleled.
    D. His contributions have been documented.

19. At the end of the speech, the speaker says that the Mongolians

    A. want to respect Genghis Khan's wish about his burial.
    B. respect Genghis Khan due to his achievements.
    C. associate Genghis Khan's burial site with his ancestral home.
    D. find it difficult to explain to outsiders why Genghis Khan's tomb is sacred.

20. The speaker gives LEAST information about

    A. Genghis Khan's victories.
    B. Genghis Khan's personal life.
    C. the legend of Genghis Khan's grave.
    D. the respect people give to Genghis Khan.

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Reading Comprehension Section

You have 30 minutes' time for this section. This section has two reading passages; each followed by 10 multiple choice questions. You are advised to spend approximately 15 minutes on each of the given passages.

Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions which follow:

Reading Passage I

"I'm a teenager trapped in an old [90-yr] body," says Betty White. What if eternal youth had essentially nothing to do with looks? Or vigour, stamina, endurance? Or, for that matter, ignorance or naiveté — which, after all, we 'outgrow' by maturity?

What if, at bottom, age — or aging — was primarily a state of mind? Fundamentally, an attitude about self, or life in general? For if this were the case, then one's youthfulness — being young not so much in body as in mind and heart — could, even after being displaced, be exultantly reclaimed. Retrieved or rescued, as it were, from the depths of consciousness, where it lay not so much buried as dormant.

So what does an anti-aging attitude consist of? What's the psychology of perpetual youth that exists independent of chronological age? What's growing evermore youthful all about? In short, how do you become ageless?

Maintain an Outlook of Innocence, Wonder, and Awe: Which means start to view things as though you've never seen them before — at least not quite in this way. Look at, or take in, the objects of your perception in a manner that enables you to appreciate them anew.

Give Rein to Your Feelings of Curiosity: How fascinating is it that what (at least metaphorically) killed the cat also brought him back? And — given, of course, that cats have nine lives (talk about perpetual youth!) — returned him to one life of satisfying curiosity after another. Those who indulge their curiosity are able to recognise things anew and anew. If you only take the time to indulge your inquisitiveness, to look — unconventionally — for new things to focus upon, things can remain indefinitely fresh.

Foster a Carefree Sense of Adventure: Much of our life may seem banal and commonplace. But consciously choosing to cultivate enthusiasm about the ordinary can actually rescue it from the dullness and reinvigorate it. Determine to make every undertaking (however matter-of-course) a challenging enterprise and every risk (even minor ones) fertile material for a memoir. So when you are near your mortal end you can look back and smile at all in life you dared to do. Consider that the greatest risk you may ever experience may be to experience no risk at all.

Staying in school will add a few years: Education is correlated with a longer life. A 2012 report from the National Centre for Health Statistics found that people with a bachelor's degree or higher, live about nine years longer than people who don't graduate high school.

Work stress isn't bad for you, necessarily: Being a hard worker doesn't necessarily mean job stress will harm you. The Longevity Study found that plenty of hard workers lived long lives.

Source: Adapted from *Into Agelessness* Psychology Today

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Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

21. In the beginning of the passage, the repetition of the phrase 'what if' creates a

A. feeling of sadness.
B. thought provoking effect.
C. feeling of liberated imagination.
D. sense of necessity for the readers.

22. The words 'vigour, stamina and endurance' in paragraph 1 are MOST closely linked to

A. aging.
B. strength.
C. ignorance.
D. consciousness.

23. Which idea about aging has been supported by the author in this text?

A. Aging is natural.
B. Age is just a number.
C. We can be healthy when we age.
D. We become more conscious of age when we grow old.

24. The MOST likely purpose of paragraph 2 is to

A. introduce what makes us ageless.
B. describe the importance of youth.
C. explain how aging affects us.
D. conclude qualities of youth.

25. The over-arching aim of this text is to communicate how to

A. keep healthy when aging.
B. escape the negative impact of aging.
C. evaluate the psychology of aging individuals.
D. avoid the onset of aging in a looks-conscious society.

26. Which two words from the text are CLOSEST in meaning?

A	Indulge	Satisfy
B	Inquisitiveness	Vigour
C	Retrieved	Cultivate
D	Banal	Dull

27. The end of paragraph 5 suggests that we should

A. keep our spirit high.
B. be insightful and intelligent.
C. participate enthusiastically in life.
D. be innovative and non-traditional.

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28. Which sentence can BEST fit and enhance the meaning of paragraph 6?

    A. Opportunity knocks once; hence, should be availed.
    B. There is no discovery or happiness without risk.
    C. Risk-taking should wait till you are ready.
    D. Be cautious while utilising opportunities.

29. According to the passage, which of the following has the BEST chance of living a long and healthy life?

    A. A college graduate with a sense of adventure
    B. A person who left studies to pursue business
    C. A curious person who does not like to work
    D. A hard-working and elderly coal-miner

30. The MAIN theme of the entire text is to

    A. suggest qualities that may help us live long.
    B. discuss how risk-taking may facilitate aging.
    C. explain why some people are healthier than others.
    D. introduce the readers to helpful suggestions related to aging.

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Now read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Reading Passage II

Why people prefer certain foods over others depends largely on a combination of taste and texture. While taste sensations are fairly well understood, scientists are just beginning to unravel the mystery of food texture.

Now, researchers at the Monell Chemical Senses Centre in Philadelphia (USA) have found that an enzyme in saliva called amylase, which breaks down starch into liquid, could play a key role in determining the appeal of various textures of food. A new genetic study shows that people produce strikingly different amounts of amylase, and that the more of the enzyme people have in their mouth, the faster they can liquefy starchy foods.

Scientists think this finding could help explain why people experience certain food items as creamy or slimy, sticky or watery, and that this perception could affect our preference for foods. For the numerous foods that contain starch, including pudding and sauces, what can feel just right to some people is experienced as too runny or not melting enough for others because they produce different amounts of the enzyme.

The ability to quickly break down starch, which is a type of carbohydrate, is only one part of the puzzle that determines what people like to eat. Taste preferences are driven by a complicated interaction between taste buds and other receptors in the mouth and nose, and the messages they send to the brain. Culture plays a role, as people tend to like foods that are familiar, says Rick Mattes, a food and nutrition professor.

Amylase and other enzymes in saliva could also help explain food texture preferences that are known to vary with age, Dr Breslin says. For instance, many young children dislike certain fruits because of a perceived sliminess — think of the inside of a tomato. But people's saliva-flow rate tends to slow with age, which might affect their ability to break down starch in the mouth and reduce sensations of sliminess.

Another factor in food preferences: people vary — probably based on genetics — in their ability to detect other textures, such as fat, bitter and sweet tastes. Valerie Duffy, a registered dietitian, has shown in her research that adults with a gene that makes bitter tastes more intense consume fewer vegetables containing bitter compounds, such as kale or spinach.

But that genetic preference can be changed by repeatedly exposing the individual to the taste or by masking the bitterness, even at an early age, she has found. In a preliminary study with preschoolers, Dr Duffy's group added a sweet taste to balance out the bitterness of certain vegetables — less than half a teaspoon of sugar to a cup of broccoli or asparagus, for example, during cooking — and found that the children were more accepting of the greens. Even when the sweetness was removed, the children still liked the vegetables more than before because they had developed a positive association with them.

Source: Adapted from *The Science Behind Why We Love Ice Cream* by Shirley S. Wang

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Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

31. According to the passage, amylase is an enzyme which is helpful in

    A. diluting starchy food.
    B. thickening starchy food.
    C. digestion of liquid and starch.
    D. digestion of all types of starch.

32. Based on the information in paragraph 3, if you find custard too runny (watery) and your sister thinks the custard has an appropriate consistency, it means

    A. you digest food quickly due to amylase.
    B. you have more amylase in your stomach.
    C. your sister has more amylase in her stomach.
    D. your mouth produces different amounts of amylase.

33. According to the information given in paragraph 4, people MOST likely have a preference for those food items which

    A. are cultural.
    B. have more starch.
    C. suit their taste buds.
    D. they have grown up eating.

34. The word ‘perceived’ in line 21 is CLOSEST in meaning to

    A. sensed.
    B. disliked.
    C. extreme.
    D. imagined.

35. ‘Even if you do not like eating vegetables today, you may become a vegetarian when you are 50.’ This sentence can BEST fit and support the information given in paragraph

    A. 1.
    B. 5.
    C. 6.
    D. 7.

36. Dr Duffy’s experiment MOST closely indicates that food preferences change with

    A. time.
    B. health.
    C. gender.
    D. memory.

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37. The theme of the passage is BEST expressed as

A. taste sensations are understood, but scientists are only beginning to explore the mystery of food textures.
B. food preferences depend upon cultural reasons, which in turn are determined by practices, tradition and beliefs.
C. production of amylase is a very important factor in determining their preference of certain food over others.
D. love for food exists in people because its taste and texture is well-suited to their genetic makeup and their cultural familiarisation.

38. As compared to adults, very few children like tomatoes because

A. tomato is slimy and unhealthy.
B. children have a genetic preference for disliking tomatoes.
C. children can taste the bitterness of tomatoes more than adults.
D. children can sense the sliminess of tomatoes more than adults.

39. According to information given in paragraph 5, which person would produce the most amount of saliva?

A. A young person
B. An elderly person
C. A middle-aged man
D. A middle-aged woman

40. In this article, the author's MAIN purpose is to

A. argue why we should like cultural cuisine.
B. persuade readers to try eating different cuisines.
C. analyse why people cultivate and prefer certain tastes.
D. predict the reasons why certain food items are more delicious.

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END OF PAPER

Please use this page for rough work

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